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The Purananuru song conveys the philosophy of Tamilians. It celebrates the selfless spirit and courage of people who served society by sharing everything with their fellowmen, even something as precious and unique as the nectar of immortality. They would never do a wrong deed even if they were offered the world as a reward. It is because of such men that the world continues to exist.

About the Author

Dr. Conjeevaram Natarajan Annadurai (15 September 1909 – 3 February 1969), popularly called Arignar Anna was an Indian politician who served as the Chief Minister of Tamil Nadu (1967 – 69). He was a great orator and an acclaimed writer in Tamil. Jawaharlal Nehru hailed him as one of the greatest parliamentarians. He has published several novels, short stories and plays which incorporate political and social themes. C.N. Annadurai was awarded the Chubb Fellowship at Yale University, the first non-American to receive this honour. The same year he was awarded an honorary doctorate from Annamalai University.

Glossary:

conferred – granted a title, degree, benefit, or right

reiterate – say or do again

enunciated – spoke clearly

ruggedness – strength, toughness

repositories – storehouses

emissaries – deputies

eschewed – have nothing to do with

autocracy – government by one ruler

feudal – having to do with the Middle Ages, old

confronting – aggressively resisting

secluded spheres – isolated areas

cloistered – restricted

perseverance – continued effort, steadfastness

inherent – inborn

perils – dangers and risks

indebted – obliged to repay

tillers – persons who produce crops/ raise animals, cultivators

toilers – workers, people who perform hard physical labour

replenish – refill

despondent – depressed, frustrated

sermons – speeches on moral subjects

endowed – gifted

crusade – campaign for a good cause

inheritors – successors

lustre – glow of reflected light